

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: The printed clause, the ideals triad and the ordering problem

SYLLABUS (verbatim) -> "Social and Political Ideals : Equality, Justice, Liberty."

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three ideals are printed, and only three

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CENTRAL QUESTION -> institutions distribute STATUS, CHOICE, BURDENS and BENEFITS.

Equality and liberty each raise a claim. Who ranks the claims?

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EQUALITY

"in what respect must
persons count as
equals?"

pivot: equal moral
worth, equal concern

danger: mechanical
levelling, loss of
individuality

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THE INDETERMINACY PREMISE

liberty is silent about WHICH liberties are basic

equality is silent about WHICH equality is owed

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ORDERING / ARCHITECTONIC CLAIM -> the ranking must range over BOTH families,
therefore it is supplied from outside either one -> that criterion is JUSTICE

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OWNERSHIP FENCE democracy forms -> Forms of Government | rights, duties and
political obligation -> Individual and State | sovereign authority -> Sovereignty
welfare programmes -> Development | recognition theory -> Multiculturalism
reservation policy -> Caste: Gandhi and Ambedkar

CORPUS SHARE -> 14 of 112 parts (2018:1 2019:2 2020:1 2021:3 2022:2 2023:1 2024:2 2025:2)

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Equality - equal moral worth and the four forms

FOUNDATION -> EQUAL MORAL WORTH / EQUAL CONCERN

arbitrary hierarchy of birth, caste, race, sex or inherited privilege must

JUSTIFY itself rather than be presumed

WARNING -> equal worth $\neq$ identity of talent, desire, capacity or outcome

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FORM	SECURES	FAILS ALONE BECAUSE
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FORMAL / LEGAL equality before the law	the rule against legal privilege	it can be mere PAPER equality in a deeply unequal society
POLITICAL equal vote, eligibility	a non-oligarchic public standing	wealth can still distort actual influence
SOCIAL no stigma or status hierarchy	equal civic respect	law alone cannot deliver it; it needs reform, education, fraternity
ECONOMIC fewer unjust disparities	fair background conditions	incentive loss; may require coercive redistribution

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REPLY RAIL -> formal needs substantive support | political needs curbs on domination
social needs fraternity | economic defenders argue redistribution protects freedom

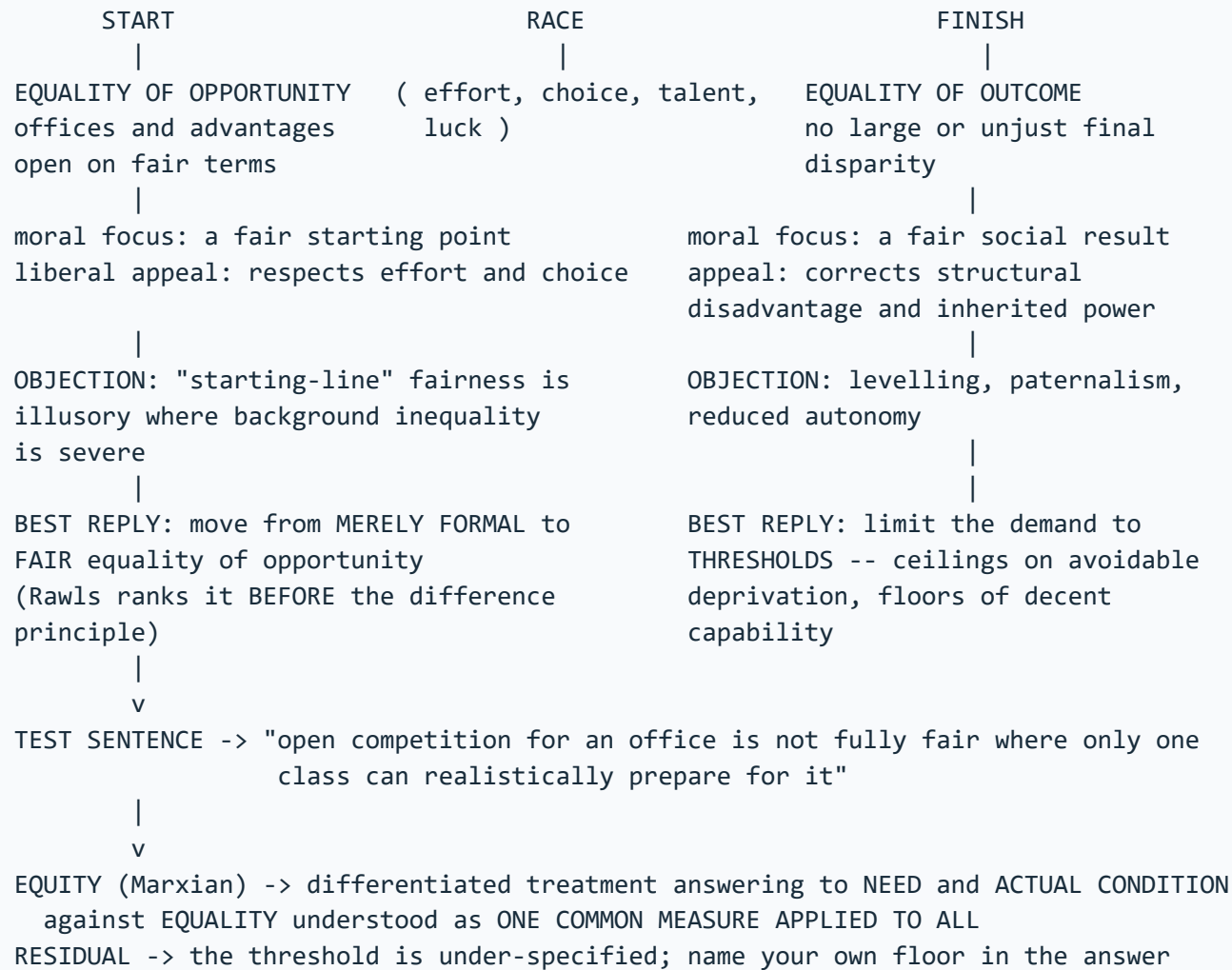
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INDIA (dated, classified) -> Articles 14-16: equality before law; prohibition of
discrimination; equality of opportunity in public employment

ENABLING CLAUSES in Articles 15 and 16 -> a PERMISSION, not a justification

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Equality - a fair starting line or a fair finishing line



ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Equality - Rousseau, Mill and Marx

ROUSSEAU	NATURAL / PHYSICAL		MORAL / POLITICAL (ARTIFICIAL)
	age, strength, health,		wealth, honour, power, dependence,
	intelligence [by nature]		social superiority [by convention]
	CONVERSION MECHANISMS -> PROPERTY + SOCIAL COMPARISON		
	EXAMPLE -> being stronger is NATURAL; COMMANDING another because convention sanctifies property and status is MORAL/POLITICAL		
	LIMIT -> not all inequality is conventional; the OPPRESSIVE forms are socially produced and socially maintained, hence remediable		
	"diagnostic, not pastoral" -> 2021 Q1(b)		

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MILL

SIX SALIENT FEATURES OF EQUALITY

- 1 equal worth in moral accounting
- 2 equality before law and equal citizenship
- 3 women's equality -- 'The Subjection of Women' (1869)
- 4 equality COMPATIBLE WITH INDIVIDUALITY
- 5 hostility to custom-made hierarchy
- 6 QUALIFIED economic concern -- reform, not coercive equalisation

GENDER ARGUMENT -> the appealed-to "nature" is MANUFACTURED by
 subjection, so the evidence is disqualified

VERDICT -> equal status WITHOUT uniformity -> 2025 Q1(e)

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MARX formal equality can CONCEAL exploitation; the wage contract APPEARS free and equal while class power shapes production and appropriation

"AN EQUAL RIGHT CAN BE A RIGHT OF INEQUALITY"

one common standard + unequal need, burden and starting position
= unequal effect

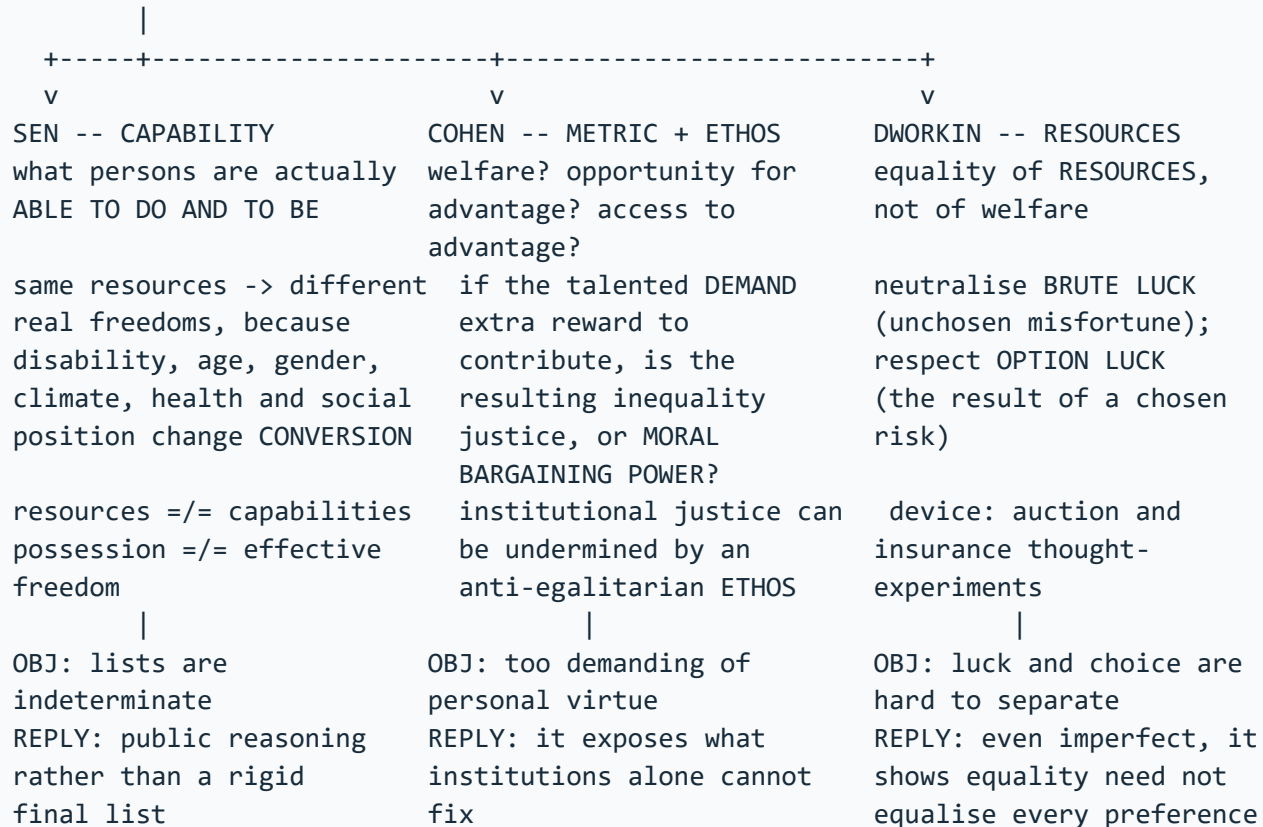
FORMULA (Critique of the Gotha Programme) -> "from each according to his ability, to each according to his need"

INDEXED TO THE HIGHER STAGE -- not a market-time salary rule

DEMANDED CONCEPT -> EQUITY vs EQUALITY -> 2022 Q2(c)

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Equality of what - Sen, Cohen and Dworkin

THE MODERN QUESTION -> not WHETHER to value equality, but EQUALITY OF WHAT



SHARED WEAKNESS -> indeterminacy exactly where policy must act

INTERIM VERDICT -> equality is strongest as EQUAL STATUS + FAIR OPPORTUNITY +
PROTECTION AGAINST ARBITRARY DOMINATION, while alert to need, capability and
historical oppression -> 2021 Q2(a)

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Liberty - Berlin's two concepts and Mill's harm principle

BASIC MEANING -> a protected sphere of action and thought; in richer accounts the power of self-direction. LIBERTY $\neq$ POWER: a tyrant has power, not liberty.

"no one is ever wholly unconstrained" is irrelevant: the theory concerns

JUSTIFIED and UNJUSTIFIED constraints

	NEGATIVE	POSITIVE
BERLIN (1958)	"within what area am I left alone?"	"who governs me? by what self am I directed?"
	freedom FROM interference	freedom TO be one's own master
	Hobbes, Locke, Mill	Rousseau, Kant, Hegel, Green
	value: protection from coercion and paternalism	value: self-mastery, rational agency, self-realisation

THE DANGER MECHANISM -> split the REAL SELF from the EMPIRICAL SELF

-> a ruler may claim to speak for the real self -> coercion is redescribed as LIBERATION. Background commitment: VALUE PLURALISM

BERLIN DOES NOT -> deny the appeal of self-mastery, nor deny social preconditions

MILL ('On Liberty', 1859) -- THE HARM PRINCIPLE

coercion of a competent adult is legitimate ONLY to prevent HARM TO OTHERS

SELF-REGARDING acts -> generally not coercible

OTHER-REGARDING acts -> may be regulated or punished

OFFENCE / DISAPPROVAL $\neq$ HARM; heterodox opinion may not be suppressed

OBJECTIONS -> few acts are cleanly self-regarding; "harm" is itself contested

BEST DEFENCE -> a BURDEN-OF-PROOF rule: coercion must show injury, not distaste, and paternalism stays exceptional

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Liberty - four specifications, sorted by the enemy each fears

THINKER	ENEMY OF FREEDOM	DEFINITION	RISK / OBJECTION
HOBBS	disorder	absence of external impediments; under law one is free WHERE THE LAW IS SILENT	liberty becomes a residual gap left by power
LOCKE	arbitrary power	liberty is not licence: it is freedom UNDER KNOWN LAW preserving life, liberty and property	property-centred liberty may mask inequality
ROUSSEAU	dependence on another's private will	obedience to a law one PRESCRIBES TO ONESELF as part of the GENERAL WILL	"forced to be free" invites an authoritarian reading
GREEN	incapacity	the POSITIVE POWER to do or enjoy something worth doing; tied to self-realisation	the state may impose a preferred conception of the good
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PRESUPPOSITIONS -> Hobbes: security is primary Locke: natural rights pre-exist government Rousseau: freedom requires participation and moral autonomy Green: the self has higher capacities that conditions foster or deform			
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GREEN'S SAFE READING -> ENABLING, not perfectionist: enlarge effective capacity and LEAVE THE CHOICE OF ENDS WITH THE AGENT. EXAMPLE -> education equips agency			
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BERLIN vs GREEN -> coercion in the name of a higher freedom, against formal liberty with no power to use it. SYNTHESIS: keep the protected sphere, add enabling conditions, refuse the authorisation to prescribe ends -> 2024 Q2(b)			

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Liberty - the threshold, technology and non-domination

THRESHOLD OF COMPLEMENTARITY

AT / BELOW -> equal basic liberties ARE a form of equality; free speech for all
is at once a liberty and an equality of civic standing; Rawls's PRIORITY RULES
block trading liberty for aggregate welfare

BEYOND -> unrestricted contract and accumulation breed inequality; aggressive
equalisation curbs choice, association and property

-> the mark-bearing move in 2018 Q2(a), 2019 Q4(b), 2022 Q1(d), 2024 Q2(b)

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TECHNOLOGICAL SOCIETY

EXPANDS knowledge, mobility, communication, range of choice

THREATENS through surveillance, manipulation and concentrated informational power

SHIFT -> coercion becomes INFRASTRUCTURAL and INFORMATIONAL, not only legal

ALGORITHMIC NUDGING -> every formal option stays open; the option taken is shaped

CONVENIENCE $\neq$ AUTONOMY

VERDICT -> realisable UNDER transparency, accountability and zones of
non-domination -> 2020 Q1(a)

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NON-DOMINATION PETTIT 1997 = the normative THEORY

SKINNER 1998 = the historical RECOVERY (never merge the two)

CASE -> a kind master or benevolent ruler who does not interfere; the dependant
still flatters, anticipates and self-censors

DISTINCTION -> INTERFERENCE is an ACT; DOMINATION is a STANDING CAPACITY to
interfere arbitrarily and with impunity

CONSEQUENCE -> non-arbitrary, contestable, interest-tracking law is
FREEDOM-CONSTITUTING, not a subtraction from liberty

OBJECTIONS -> (1) redundancy: high probability of interference would do the work
(2) indeterminacy of "arbitrary" -- answered procedurally, with a
residual problem that must be CONCEDED

INDIA (form of remedy only) -> Bonded Labour System (Abolition) Act 1976;
Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace Act 2013; Code on Wages 2019 commenced
by S.O. 5322(E), 21 November 2025 -> ENACTMENT IS NOT IMPLEMENTATION

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Justice - three forms, four dimensions, legality and legitimacy

MEANING -> what is due to each, and the principles governing distribution,
rectification, rights and the moral structure of institutions
social cooperation creates benefits and burdens; justice fixes their terms
persons are owed REASONS, not merely outcomes

LEGALITY $\neq$ JUSTICE -> a law may be valid yet unjust

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FORM	EXACT QUESTION	FAILS ALONE BECAUSE
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FORMAL	are announced principles applied impartially and consistently to like cases?	an unjust principle can be applied with perfect consistency
PROCEDURAL	was the decision produced by fair rules, hearing, publicity, impartiality and non-cheating?	a fair-looking procedure can run on a grossly unequal background
SUBSTANTIVE	are the governing principle, the distribution and the social relations themselves just?	an outcome imposed without due process becomes a second arbitrariness

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CONCLUSION -> FAIR PROCEDURE *PLUS* A DEFENSIBLE SUBSTANTIVE CRITERION

EXAMPLE -> equal legal punishment for unequal wrongdoing satisfies consistency and violates corrective fairness

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FOUR DIMENSIONS -> LEGAL (impartial administration AND whether law answers to justice) | POLITICAL (equal citizenship, voice, non-arbitrary public power) | SOCIO-ECONOMIC (benefits, burdens, real opportunities) | RECOGNITION-STATUS (whether institutions reproduce stigma, humiliation, second-class standing)

BRIDGE -> LEGALITY = a rule's valid place in a legal system; LEGITIMACY = morally justified authority to those subject to it. SOURCE CONTROL -> Gauba pp. 442-445; Socio-Political Philosophy pp. 40, 47-54; Cambridge Dictionary pp. 489-490

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Justice - Plato, Aristotle, the criteria problem, compensation

PLATO CITY: rulers rule | auxiliaries defend | producers provide
SOUL: reason governs | spirit supports | appetite obeys
JUSTICE = each part doing its OWN work without usurping another's role
-> inner AND civic RIGHT-ORDER, not merely external distribution
OBJ frozen hierarchy | REPLY a norm of competence and organic harmony
VERDICT -> the idea survives the institution -> 2024 Q1(a)

ARISTOTLE DISTRIBUTIVE -> shares track RELEVANT desert -> PROPORTIONAL equality
(offices, honours)
CORRECTIVE -> restore the balance after a wrong -> ARITHMETIC equality
(compensation, restitution, punishment)
RULE -> treat equals equally and unequals unequally ONLY where the basis
of comparison is RELEVANT. GAP -> "relevant" is left unspecified

CRITERIA GRID NEED -> subsistence, health care, basic education, disability
DESERT -> honours; backward-looking and moralised
MERIT -> offices; forward-looking and functional
CONTRIBUTION / ENTITLEMENT -> wages, exchange, property titles
EQUAL SHARE -> civil and political rights, one person one vote
COMPENSATION -> rectification of unjustified prior loss

THESIS -> justice is CRITERION-PLURAL but NOT ARBITRARY: each good has an internal
logic fixing its proper basis. MERIT $\neq$ DESERT -> collapsing them
yields the bad answer that "merit is a moral entitlement"

INJUSTICE -> a criterion ESCAPING ITS SPHERE: wealth buying political influence;
caste rank governing access to office

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COMPENSATORY PRINCIPLE -> corrective justice generalised from transactions

- 1 systematic, legally sanctioned exclusion from land, education, office, honour
- 2 exclusion TRANSMITS through wealth, networks, schooling, health, confidence
- 3 formal equality from today RATIFIES the unequal starting line
- 4 positive measures offset the transmitted disadvantage
- 5 therefore compensation is demanded BY equality, not as an exception to it

TERMINUS -> it lapses when the targeted transmission no longer operates
RESIDUAL -> over-inclusion; the transmission premise is FACTUAL and must be argued
ROUTING -> the affirmative-action policy debate belongs to the CASTE owner

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Justice - utilitarian aggregation, Rawls, Nozick, Sen, Ambedkar

UTILITARIAN	institutions are just if they MAXIMISE aggregate welfare; rightness is consequence-based, not prior-rights-based AGGREGATION OBJECTION -> individuals, minorities and the least advantaged may be sacrificed if the total rises rule / indirect replies -> rights are protected only CONTINGENTLY
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RAWLS (1971)	ORIGINAL POSITION + VEIL OF IGNORANCE [a DEVICE OF REPRESENTATION, not a historical contract] P1 equal BASIC LIBERTIES LEXICALLY PRIOR P2a FAIR EQUALITY OF OPPORTUNITY prior to P2b P2b DIFFERENCE PRINCIPLE benefit the LEAST ADVANTAGED method -> REFLECTIVE EQUILIBRIUM one line -> DEONTOLOGICAL LIBERAL EGALITARIANISM -> 2023 Q1(a), 2019 Q1(a)
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NOZICK (1974)	acquisition transfer RECTIFICATION HISTORICAL principles against PATTERNED principles WILT CHAMBERLAIN -> start from any just distribution, allow only voluntary transfers, and the pattern breaks MINIMAL STATE -> force, theft, fraud and contract enforcement only CRITICISM -> starting points are never clean, and rectification is UNDER-SPECIFIED -> 2021 Q1(a)
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SEN	NITI = correctness of institutions, rules and procedures NYAYA = justice AS REALISED in people's lives COMPARATIVE, not TRANSCENDENTAL institutionalism CAPABILITY + PUBLIC REASONING OBJECTION -> under-determination between rival improvements -> 2021 Q2(a)
AMBEDKAR	political democracy is UNSTABLE without SOCIAL DEMOCRACY rooted in LIBERTY, EQUALITY and FRATERNITY; constitutional FORM != lived social democracy; one vote each can coexist with civic humiliation -> 2018 Q2(a), 2025 Q4(a)

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Debates, traps, PYQ anchors, answer spine, qualified verdict

SIX DEBATES Hobbes / Locke / Rousseau -- order, rights, or collective autonomy?
 Berlin vs Green -- coercion for a higher freedom, or hollow liberty?
 Rawls vs Nozick -- fair agreement, or self-ownership?
 Rawls vs Sen -- ideal structure, or remediable injustice?
 Mill vs Marx -- individuality, or the material limits of formal equality?
 Procedure vs Substance -- was a fair rule followed, or is the rule just?
 PLATO -> RAWLS: the QUESTION is inherited, the ANSWER is rejected

TEN TRAPS equality as sameness | Berlin as anti-positive | Mill as licence |
Rousseau's natural inequality as rightlessness | Rawls with equality
first | Nozick as patterned | Sen as welfare economics | Ambedkar as a
name-drop | justice collapsed into law or procedure | one-sided answers

PYQ ANCHORS 2018 Q2(a) 20 liberty and equality distinctive of democracy?
2019 Q1(a) 10 is Rawls continuing Plato? 2019 Q4(b) 15 does liberty
limit equality? 2020 Q1(a) 10 liberty in technological society?
2021 Q1(a) 10 Nozick's distributive theory 2021 Q1(b) 10 Rousseau on
natural against artificial inequality 2021 Q2(a) 20 is Sen an
improvement upon Rawls? 2022 Q1(d) 10 complete liberty / order and
restriction 2022 Q2(c) 15 equity against equality in Marxian philosophy
2023 Q1(a) 10 justice as fairness 2024 Q1(a) 10 Plato on justice
2024 Q2(b) 15 critically evaluate liberty and equality 2025 Q1(e) 10
Mill's salient features of equality 2025 Q4(a) 20 equality and liberty
inadequate without justice

ANSWER SPINE 10m ~150w -> doctrine -> argument spine -> ONE evidence unit, its limit, and a graded verdict

15m ~220w -> axis of dispute -> side A -> side B -> ONE worked objection-reply -> two evidence units -> conditional verdict

20m ~300w -> thesis -> concept map and criterion -> strongest case -> strongest rival -> two objection-reply chains with RESIDUAL problems -> comparative adjudication -> one dated Indian illustration -> a graded verdict that concedes something to the losing side

QUALIFIED VERDICT -> liberty and equality are indispensable but each is INDETERMINATE about which liberties and equalities matter; JUSTICE supplies the ordering criterion, and because rival theories order them differently it must be EXPLICIT and DEFENSIBLE.